

The DROWSY
CHAPERONE

BOOK BY:

BOB MARTIN AND
DON MCKELLAR

MUSIC AND LYRICS BY:

LISA LAMBERT AND
GREG MORRISON

DIRECTED BY

LORRAINE PORTMAN

SPONSORED BY
MIKE & MARY JO
SCHWEIGER

**Feb 21-
March 16**



Original Broadway production of The Drowsy Chaperone produced by Kevin McCollum, Roy Miller, Bob Boyett, Stephanie McClelland, Barbara Freitag and Jill Furman. The Drowsy Chaperone is presented through special arrangement with Music Theatre International (MTI). All authorized performance materials are also supplied by MTI. www.mtishows.com

FROM THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR



What led me to choose this musical for our season, specifically during this time of year, is the need for an uplift coming out of the holidays. After the cold days of winter, a hearty splash of joy checks all the boxes and gives us a dose of escapism. This campy, whimsical show encompasses elements of depth too, as the narrating “man in chair” shares his personal reasons for why he is drawn to the actors in this show.

As the story comes to life from his imagination, his interaction with the characters reveals his deep need for human connection, but unfortunately, not one that is easy to embrace in real life. Sometimes imagination and fantasy are where we feel most safe, but in this man’s joyful, and at times melancholy journey, he explores why he has ended up alone and finds comfort in his favorite musical. I hope you will enjoy his journey and find inspiration that, as we sometimes stumble along through life’s funny path, we hold out hope to hear that one sweet song that brings us enough joy to get us through tough times.

-Sherrie Provence, Executive Director of the Limelight Theatre

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

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Director's Note



If every story has been told, what stories are there to tell? Stories that look back and look forward, with all the stories that have come before as reference points. Our modern musicals come from musicals that have come before, sometimes without obvious references. In this case, we have a musical that is rich with references, a musical that looks back with love and irreverence at musicals that have come before.

Drowsy Chaperone started as a series of skits to celebrate the wedding of the real Robert (Bob) Martin and Janet Van de Graaff. Their talented friends created and performed a series of songs and sketches sending up early American musicals. In *Drowsy Chaperone* what we see on stage is what the Man in Chair creates in his mind, his idea of the *Drowsy Chaperone*. He talks to us, the audience, and we see on stage what his imagination brings to life.

The musicals that inspired *Drowsy Chaperone* are well loved. *Guys & Dolls*. *42nd Street*. This is a post modern musical, one that plays with the conventions of musicals. The best comedies are about something authentic. Under the laughs, there is a conversation about something emotional and true. With *Drowsy Chaperone*, there is a conversation about loneliness, connection, love, and the magic of theatre. Theatre makes connection possible, makes love possible, makes dreams coming true possible.

I have been honored and thrilled to work with this talented cast. I am deeply grateful to this cast and crew and to all of you, our audience, who join us as we bring *Drowsy Chaperone* to life.

-Lorraine Portman

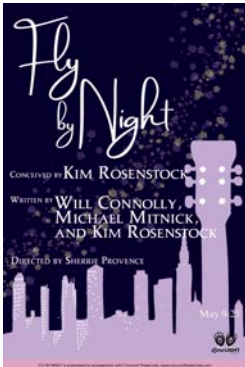
A very special thanks to:

Sherrie Provence, Curtis Powell, Jonathan Chapman, Don Cupo,
Rae Natazz, Michael Takita, Linda Takita, Rob O'Leary, Sue
Schwartz, Lourdes Acosta, Ryan Provence, David Buchman,
Mike and Mary Jo Schweiger,
City Gate Distillery,
St. Augustine Distillery,
Daisy, Errol, Anthony, and Tony.

Cast

THE DROWSY CHAPERONE.....	SHERRIE PROVENCE
ALDOLPHO.....	BLAKE OSNER
MAN IN CHAIR.....	BILL RAINS
JANET VAN DE GRAAF.....	JESSICA ALEXANDER
ROBERT MARTIN.....	JIMMY ALEXANDER
MRS. TOTTENDALE.....	HEATHER STARLING
UNDERLING.....	CLAY MITCHELL
GANGSTER #1.....	JEFF SHAEFFER
GANGSTER #2.....	ANTHONY ROMERO
FELDZIEG.....	COLLIN JAMES
KITTY.....	JOELLIE TUCKER
TRIX THE AVIATRIX.....	JOY MANNING
MAID.....	KAYLA FOSTER
GEORGE.....	RONALD FOSTER

UPCOMING AUDITIONS!



2/22/25
Saturday
11:00AM



3/8/25
Saturday
11:00AM



4/26/25
Saturday
11:00AM

Crew

Director.....	Lorraine Portman
Music Director.....	Curtis Powell
Choreographer.....	Jonathan Chapman
Stage Manager.....	Rae Natzel
Set Design.....	Rob O’leary
Costume Design.....	Linda Takita
Lighting Design.....	Michael Takita
Airplane Design & Construction.....	Rob O’Leary
Light Board Operator.....	Ashley Taylor
Sound Board Operator.....	Francesca Bellavista
Technical Director.....	Don Cupo
Props.....	Don Cupo
Paint Charge.....	Sue Schwartz
Scenic Paint.....	Lourdes Acosta
Construction.....	Don Cupo
	Charles Ross
Production Manager.....	Don Cupo
Photographer.....	Ryan Provence
Trailer.....	Charity Walton
Interns.....	Kiah Cautilli & Emma “Ruby” Parker

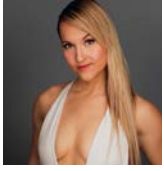
**“GREAT THEATRE IS ABOUT CHALLENGING HOW
WE THINK AND ENCOURAGING US TO
FANTASIZE ABOUT A WORLD WE ASPIRE TO.”**

-WILLEM DAFOE

*Thank you for supporting community theatre.
Ned & Paula Skinner*

Cast & Crew

Jessica Alexander

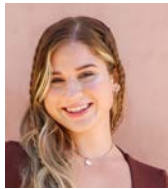


Jessica (Janet Van De Graaf) is thrilled to help bring this magnificent, colorful, sparkling world to you all. She returns to the Limelight stage after her performance of “O Holy Night” in our recent *Christmas Cabaret*, her portrayal of Sheryl Hoover in last season’s *Little Miss Sunshine*, as well as countless other roles here since 2008. Jessica is beyond blessed to be performing this show with her family: her husband, daughter, and son-in-law. You may see Jessica on your TV screens soon singing in a feature-length film *The Darkness Returns*, available on streaming platforms. A gigantic thank you goes out to her director Lorraine for making this dream come true and big hugs & kisses go out to her other children. Find her at www.jessicaalexander.org.

Jimmy Alexander



Jimmy Alexander (Robert) is so happy to be back in the Limelight. You last saw him as Richard in *Little Miss Sunshine*. He is also reuniting with his wonderful director, Lorraine, who directed him in *Duck Hunter Shoots Angel* over 10 years ago. Other favorite shows include five different productions of *The Rocky Horror Show* (Rocky/Riff Raff), *American Idiot* (St. Jimmy), *Rent* (The Man/Collins), *Oklahoma!* (Curly), and *Xanadu* (Zeus.) Jimmy recently shot a feature film that should be out any day now and is working on another project that is currently trying to get on its feet. Jimmy is very excited that this show is a family affair, performing alongside his wife, Jess, oldest daughter, Kayla, and new son-in-law, Ronnie. Thanks to the entire creative team.



Kayla Foster

Kayla (Maid) is so excited to be performing at The Limelight Theatre again after appearing in their KidzACTory production of *The Little Mermaid* many years ago! She was last seen on stage as Babette in *Beauty and the Beast*. Sharing the stage with her husband and parents has been such a joy, and she will always be grateful to them for introducing her to the world of musical theatre. She sends a heartfelt thank you to her family and friends for their continued support and hopes you all enjoy this goofy show!



Ronald Foster

This is Ronald’s (George) Limelight Theatre debut! He is so excited to be playing as George alongside his in-laws, wife, and some amazing friends. Ronald has been seen as Bernardo in *West Side Story* and Lumiere in *Beauty and the Beast*. He wants to thank everyone for coming to see the show.

Collin James



Collin James (Feldzieg) is excited to make his return to the Limelight Theatre’s stage after appearing in *First Date* as Reggie and others. Collin is a graduate of the Florida School of the Arts, earning an Associate’s degree in Acting. Collin has been acting for more than ten years in numerous theatres throughout Central Florida playing various roles such as Nick Bottom in *A Midsummer Night’s Dream*, Charlie Brown in *You’re a Good Man Charlie Brown*, Radar O’ Riley in *M*A*S*H*, Adam/Himself in *The Complete Works of William Shakespeare Abridged* (Revised), Albus Dumbledore in *A Very Potter Musical*, and many more.

Cast & Crew

Joy Manning



Joy (Trix) is a native Floridian and a recently retired Saint Johns County teacher who loves acting, writing, singing, and anything that makes her laugh and brings people together. She has been a patron of the Limelight Theatre for many years and is also a Flagler College Alumni who has performed in several college and local theatrical productions. Joy's favorite roles include: Jessie in *Storefront Church* by John Patrick Shanley, The Voice in *Step On A Crack* by Suzan Zeder, Wicked Witch in *The Wizard of Oz* by L. Frank Baum, Understanding Angel in Charles Tazewall's, *The Littlest Angel*, and Mrs. O'Brien in *Threads of Silver and Gold: Woman of the Panama*

Canal by local playwright and director, Deborah Dickey. Above all, Joy's most cherished gift is spending time with family and friends, especially, the loves of her life— daughters: Criston, Tracey, Shiray, and grandson Gabriel.

Clay Mitchell



Clay (Underling) is thrilled to return to the Limelight to perform as Underling in *The Drowsy Chaperone*. He was most recently seen at the Limelight as Hugo in *Tuck Everlasting* and as Uncle Frank in *Little Miss Sunshine*. Clay deeply appreciates his soon-to-be husband, Zach, for his unwavering support during the busy weeks of rehearsals for a show about a wedding, just weeks before their own.

Blake Osner



Blake (Aldolpho) is a well-recognized singer, actor, director, and producer, having performed with various organizations in the NE Florida area for over 20 years. Limelight patrons may recall Blake from past productions, including *Hands On A Hardbody*, *The Full Monty*, and *Patsy Cline*. He has been busy this theatre season in productions of *Broadway Bash* and *Four Old Broads* (All Beaches Experimental Theatre), *Mame!* (Florida Theatre), and *Just Deserts* (Theatre Jacksonville). Other favorites from past seasons include *Sylvia* (Players by the Sea), *Phantom* (All Beaches Experimental), *Love, Valor, Compassion!* (5&Dime) and *Rocky Horror* (RHSLive Productions).

Sherrie Provence



Sherrie (Drowsy Chaperone) serves as Executive Director of the Limelight. She is a SAG-AFTRA and AEA actress with a MFA in Acting and BA in Theatre. She has acted and directed on stages in London, Scotland, Russia, Ukraine, Germany, and Austria. She has worked with producers, directors, and writers to help produce original work for Broadway and off-Broadway. As a professional, she has worked as an actress, director, writer, producer, and Professor of Theatre at several universities. She founded three theatre companies and a production company in Atlanta, GA, where she worked with Turner Broadcasting, A&E Network, and 20th Century Fox. She has been able to work with stars Donald Glover, Tyler Perry, Tony Hale, Jim Carrey, Clint Eastwood and others, guest starring herself both in television and in film. She is the mother of two adult children who are her heart and soul (Layne and LB) and is married to her hero (Ryan.) She believes hope and light are essential to her calling as a storyteller and tries to incorporate both in every area of her work. Grateful ...

Cast & Crew

Bill Rains



Bill (Man in Chair) moved from Southern California a few years ago and has been delighting audiences since he was 14 (quite some time ago...) He's excited to be playing one of his dream roles at the Limelight, and this marks his fourth show here. Some of Bill's previous roles include Aldolpho in *The Drowsy Chaperone*, Joe Keller in *All My Sons*, Daddy Warbucks in *Annie*, and Baptista in *The Taming of the Shrew*.

Anthony Romero



Anthony Romero (Gangster #2) is in his 3rd show here at the Limelight Theatre. He is very excited to be playing this character on stage with fellow cast members. This character is very different from what he's played in the past and is definitely his style of character. He is excited to see what he can do with the character to make the audience love him as much as he does. Anthony wants to show audiences an evolution of this small character throughout this show.

Jeff Shaeffer



Jeff (Gangster #1/Super) most recently played the role of Stanford Adams in Limelight's production of *Bright Star*. Before finding Limelight, Jeff did other roles in other places. Joe Hardy in *Damn Yankees*. Sky Masterson in *Guys & Dolls*. Bo Decker in *Bus Stop*, as well as a number of other roles in T.V. and film when living in California. He received his A.A. degree from Dade South College and his B.F.A. from the University of Miami. He followed that with a scholarship at the Lee Strasberg Institute in New York City and voice training with Dr. Robert Brewster in Miami. Jeff is so very happy and humbled to be a part of the Limelight family.

Heather Starling



Heather (Mrs. Tottendale) is delighted to make her Limelight Theatre debut! Most recently seen as Elizabeth in *Young Frankenstein* at Saltwater Performing Arts, Heather's other favorite roles are Casey in *First Date* and Judy in *9 to 5* (Amelia Community Theatre), Lucy in *Jekyll & Hyde*, and Pickles in *Great American Trailer Park* (Amelia Musical Playhouse). Thank you, Lorraine, for this opportunity and for being so kind, this incredible ensemble for being so supportive, and her husband, Daniel, for always believing in her! All my love to Benny, Bailey, Bea, and Bruce.

Joellie Tucker



Joellie (Kitty) is delighted to be making her debut with the Limelight Theatre. Recent credits of hers include *Eurydice* with Florida School of the Arts, *The Drowsy Chaperone*, and *A Christmas Carol* with Palatka High School. Her favorite show she has performed in so far is *Titanic: The Musical* with Palatka High School, where she played Charlotte Cardoza. She is currently a student at Florida School of the Arts and plans on earning her Master of Fine Arts degree in musical theatre. After earning her degree, she plans to continue acting. She has always dreamed of pursuing a career in film.

Cast & Crew

Francesca Bellavista



Francesca (Sound Board Operator) is once again very happy to have the best seat in the house up in the sound booth for this toe-tapping musical delight! Francesca has been involved at the Limelight Theatre for 10 years as an actor, director, stage manager, and past Board Member. She is also involved with A Classic Theatre, appearing in the one-woman show Shirley Valentine in 2024, and also with Jason Woods Productions as the Narrator in *The Little Toy Shoppe*. Francesca loves the theatre for the teamwork, collaboration, sharing of talents and the immense support that everybody gives each other.

Johnathan Chapman



Jonathan Chapman (Choreographer) was raised in Atlanta, Georgia, beginning his dance education at the age of 13 with Stacey Herrington, Mandy Neeley, Amy Lindsey, Jeremy K and Tara Drew - training in ballet, modern, contemporary, jazz, and tap. He was accepted on full scholarship into the Belhaven University Dance Department in Jackson, Mississippi where he received training from instructors that included Stephen Wynne, Laura Morton and Cynthia Newland. Jonathan then joined Ballet Magnificat!'s Professional Trainee Program under the guidance of Kathy Thibodeaux, Jiri Voborsky and Sol Nazario. He joined the Ballet Magnificat! Company in 2008 and was promoted to Company Artist, which he held until 2014.

With Ballet Magnificat!, as well as a freelance performer with many companies, he has traveled nationally and internationally dancing in classical and contemporary works on four continents. Currently, he and his wife lead an amazing team at St. Augustine Dance Conservatory and The Perla Ballet in St. Augustine, Florida. His choreography ranges from classical ballet and contemporary, to tap and jazz.

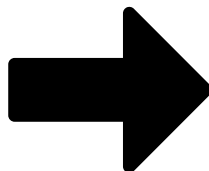
Don Cupo



Don (Technical Director/ Production Manager) is a jack of all trades in entertainment. He's been a scholarship student in New York City studying jazz, tap, ballet, and acrobatics. He studied voice and theatre at H.B. Studios and learned how to play all instruments in the orchestra. He has a BFA in Film from the University of Central Florida. He received his backstage training at the Edison Valley Playhouse in Edison, N.J., and the Take a Chance Theatre, in Winter Park, FL. He is an accomplished playwright and composer. Two of his plays, *Ashes to Ashes* and *A Person's Proof*, and his musical *Jury* have all had their world premiere at the Take a Chance Theatre. He has directed and produced three short films, *Raging Ravioli*, *The Fountain of Arima*, and *Garden Therapy* which premiered at the Fort Myers Film Festival. When he was 48, he went back to college and became the oldest member of the University of Central Florida marching band. He is currently working on a few screenplays, a novel, a suite, and even a board game. He'd like to thank Bucky for all his love and support, and for suggesting him for the Technical Director position at the Limelight Theatre.

TAKE OUR ANONYMOUS SURVEY!

This survey helps us learn more about our audience in order to obtain grant funding and sponsorships. It takes 30 seconds. Thank you for helping Limelight become the best it can be.



Cast & Crew

Rae Natzel



Rae (Stage Manager) is a Flagler College graduate with a Bachelors of Art in theatre arts. They studied both carpentry and lighting design, and spent three years as a scene shop work study employee. When not here in St. Augustine they can be found summering in Colorado, where they are entering their fourth summer with Theatre Aspen as Assistant Technical Director. Notable shows include *Cinderella* (Lighting Designer, ASM, Flagler College), *Every Brilliant Thing* (Technical Director, Flagler College), *Jersey Boys* (Carpentry Apprentice, Theatre Aspen), *Rent* (Carpenter, Stage

crew Theatre Aspen), *Come From Away* (Carpenter, Theatre Aspen), and Theatre Aspen's Summer Cabaret series (Technical Director). They hope you enjoy this cast and crew's hard work and dedication, and come see the rest of our season here at the Limelight! @natazz1011

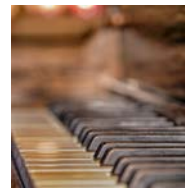
Lorraine Portman



Lorraine Portman (Director) is thrilled to return to Limelight Theatre. She directed *Duck Hunter Shoots Angel* in 2011. She has also directed a number of productions for The Flagler Playhouse, including *Once Upon a Mattress* and *Dixie Swim Club*. Lorraine Portman is an award-winning filmmaker, screenwriter, and produced playwright. Portman has directed eight short films and a feature. Her newest short film is a documentary titled *Unlikely Mermaid* which is currently playing film festivals. Notable awards include

The Paul Schrader Best Screenplay Award for *The King's Inn* given by Cayman International Film Festival. The Bare Bones International Independent Film Festival recognized Portman in 2018 with the Lois Weber Legacy Award and The Indie Filmmaker Spirit Award in 2017. She was awarded The Denis Johnston Playwriting Award for her one-act play *Small Animals*. Portman taught Playwriting and Screenwriting at Flagler College. She holds a Bachelor of Arts in theater from Smith College and Master of Fine Arts in film from Florida State University. Portman also attended the National Theater Institute at the Eugene O'Neill Theater Center.

Curtis Powell



Curtis Powell is widely recognized throughout the North Florida area as a leading pianist, accompanist/collaborator and music director, and maintains an active performance schedule. Mr. Powell has over 150 musical theater production credits to his name. There are also over 100 sacred, oratorio and opera productions he has been involved in. He has performed throughout the United States and Europe. Currently Powell serves as the Director of Music at Ancient City Baptist Church in St. Augustine. He is also the founder of the Summer Musical TheatreCamp for teens and kids. For a tenth year he is a visiting Guest Artist at Douglas Anderson School of the Arts in Jacksonville, vocal coaching and collaborating with musical theater students.

Mr. Powell has previously been recognized by the St. Johns County Commission for his contribution to the arts. EMMA – The St. Augustine Concert Association – has made him an honorary board member for his work on their behalf. In 2015 he was recognized as one of “10 Who Make a Difference” in St. Augustine.

Cast & Crew

Linda Takita



Linda (Costume Designer) is a recipient of Hawaii State Theatre Council's award for lifetime achievement in theatre in Hawaii. Linda was originally a music therapy major but the "theatre bug" caught her when she performed in her very first play at Alverno College in Milwaukee. Consequently, she transferred to the University of Detroit majoring in theatre and later received her degree as Bachelor of Liberal Studies from Chaminade University. In Ohio, Linda taught and acted at Height's Youth Theatre, a professional children's theatre, and performed at Chagrin Valley Little Theatre before she moved to Maui in 1973. There she co-founded Maui Academy of Performing Arts, and Maui Youth Theatre, with her husband Michael. As Executive Artistic Director she wrote, produced, directed and choreographed over 100 productions some of which toured schools throughout Hawaii and were presented on television and radio as well as at hotels and shopping centers. She created drama education programs for the theatre and for Hawaii schools. As a director, some of her favorites are *Once on This Island*, *Rashomon* and *Willie Wonka and the Chocolate Factory*. Some favorite acting roles are Rose in *Gypsy*, Mame in *Mame*, and Annie Sullivan in *The Miracle Worker*. Linda enjoys traveling with her husband, gardening, reading and spending time with their 6 children, 11 grandchildren and 3 great-grandchildren. She is also happy to be a part of Limelight Theatre where she has done costumes for *Independence* and recently *Crimes of the Heart*.

Michael Takita



Michael Takita is a lighting designer originally from Maui. He has resided in California and, subsequently, in France before recently relocating to St. Augustine, where he is pleased to become a member of the Limelight Theatre family. Mr. Takita has been engaged in theatre since his high school years and has retired from his position as the Director of Information Technology at a prominent CPA firm in California. He has been a lighting designer for numerous organizations, including Maui Academy of Performing Arts, Maui

Onstage, Tahiti Productions, Baldwin Theatre Guild, and Les Troubadours Britanniques de Limoux in France. Furthermore, he co-founded the Maui Academy of Performing Arts, established 50 years ago. At the Limelight Theatre, Mr. Takita has designed lighting for several productions, including *Independence*, *First Date*, *Christmas Cabaret*, and *Crimes of the Heart*.

What's up next in Limelight Education?

Our littlest performers will get to explore the fundamentals of musical theatre while singing and dancing to songs from *Aladdin*. Class session will end with an informal showcase for friends and family on May 1 @ 4:45pm.

*Please note, this is not a fully produced production. Students will be working on 4 to 5 songs from the musical.



EDUCATION!

